

Chapter 57-1

Jingyi Culture, seventh floor office.

A woman in a light gray suit leaned back, letting all her weight rest on the swivel chair. One hand rested on the armrest while the other held her phone face-down.

The green plants in the office had withered and yellowed, and the cactus on the desk looked gray and lifeless, completely devoid of vitality.

Two computers sat on the wooden desk, both powered on.

Messages kept popping up from below the computer screens.

One computer displayed Weibo, the other showed a green social media app.

The trending topics on Weibo were diverse, but several were particularly eye-catching:

《Afterglow》 Divine Cast#

#Zhao Ying 《Afterglow》 Stills#

#Yang Shuyan Special Appearance in 《Afterglow》 #

#Zhao Ying Yang Shuyan Possible Century Collaboration#

#Last-minute Replacement Young Lady Stars in 《Afterglow》 #

#Chen Liuying Loses 《Afterglow》 Role#

Although 《Afterglow》 was a typical yuri¹ urban drama, it had an excellent creative team, with the script written by renowned industry screenwriter Luo Pianran. It told the story of two girls' completely different lives.

The female lead was a fallen wealthy heiress, the second female lead was a perfectionist with obsessive cleanliness. Almost all the storylines centered on the female lead, while the third female role was the most important link in the female lead's story arc—a white lotus turned villain².

When Bai Weiwei first read the script, she immediately fell in love with this character. If Chen Liuying could play it well, it would be a turning point in her career.

Chen Liuying was also the strongest competitor for this role.

Although it was an open casting call for society, Chen Liuying's acting skills, popularity, and looks gave her absolute advantages among all competitors.

To secure this role, she even sent Chen Liuying to study with the best acting teacher at the Film Academy.

All this was just to have the most outstanding performance during that day's audition.

Chen Liuying's acting skills improved qualitatively in a short time.

Bai Weiwei had also indirectly inquired with the drama's producer, who said that for the third female role, the investors hadn't inserted anyone, and the director had no suitable candidate in mind. As long as Chen Liuying didn't make mistakes, she would definitely pass.

After all, she had traffic³.

Which drama would refuse to let a naturally trending actress play a supporting role?

So Bai Weiwei was very confident.

But she hadn't expected to encounter Liang Shi on audition day.

When Chen Liuying and Liang Shi competed for the same role, her heart still leaned toward Chen Liuying.

After all, for someone who had never acted before, she might shine in one performance due to her natural compatibility with the character.

But it was impossible to directly challenge such a demanding role right from the start.

You must know, this character's multiple reversals—even if Zhao Ying herself played it, she couldn't portray it thoroughly and penetratingly.

But after watching Liang Shi's audition that day, Bai Weiwei was shocked.

So talent could easily crush hard work.

She later inquired with 《Afterglow》's producer, who gave evasive responses. In the end, she couldn't secure this role.

Today was the day 《Afterglow》 released their character posters, and trending topics belonging to 《Afterglow》 dominated one after another.

Mixed among these trending topics was also Minghui Jewelry's autumn new collection launch.

Minghui Jewelry's autumn new products were eye-catching, receiving nothing but praise.

Bai Weiwei looked through all the trending topics again and again. After unlocking her phone screen, what appeared was the video she had recorded that day.

In the shopping mall's restroom, she had pushed Chen Liuying against the wall twice.

Footnotes: ¹ Yuri: A genre focusing on romantic relationships between women; in Chinese web novels, refers to GL (Girls' Love) stories ² White lotus turned villain: A character archetype that appears innocent and pure but reveals a dark, manipulative nature ³ Traffic: Industry term referring to an actor's ability to generate online buzz, views, and fan engagement